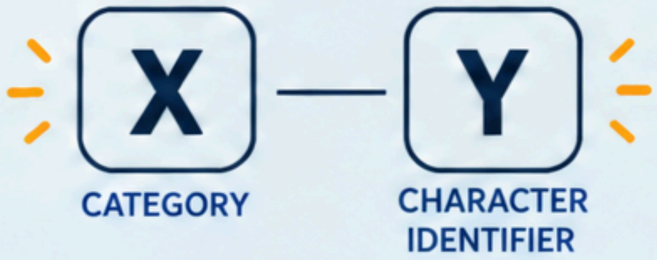
EXTENSIBLE PAO SYSTEM

MODULE: BASICS

The first digit indicates which category the character belongs to. The second indicates the specific character.



XY = Category(X) + CharacterID(Y)

The 2-digit code identifies the CHARACTER.



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X CATEGORY MAP

0 [S] SHOWBUSINESS
actors • musicians



1 [A] ART
art creators



2 [M] MYTHS
myths • legends



3 [G] GRAPHICS
cartoon • anime • games



4 [R] RESEARCH
scientists • explorers



5 [U] UNREAL
fantasy • sci-fi



6 [H] HISTORY
rulers • politicians



7 [I] INVENTORS
inventors • engineers



8 [P] PLAYERS
sports • competition



9 [L] LITERATURE
fictional people



LETTER ANCHOR

S	A	M	G	R	U	H	I	P	L
0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9

The first letter of the category is anchored in the Universal Letter-Based Major System.

HOW TO READ THE CODE

4Y

4 → [R]esearch

4Y = a character from the Research category

Y = identifier of a specific character

REMEMBER

LEFT SIDE = BROAD
selects the category (context).

RIGHT SIDE = MORE SPECIFIC
indicates the specific character.

X → category | XY → specific character | XYZ... → refinement

EXTENSIBLE PAO SYSTEM

MODULE: GENERATION

Y indicates which specific character to choose within a given category.
The rule depends on the type of Person.

HOW IS Y FORMED? – 4 STEPS



Y = first letter of the identifying name → digit

Use the Universal Letter-Based Major System to convert the letter into a digit.



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TWO WAYS TO FORM Y

1 FOR CATEGORIES 0, 1, 4, 6, 7, 8, 9

USE THE FIRST LETTER OF THE **SURNAME**





Albert **Einstein** → Einstein → **E** → **3**



Pablo **Picasso** → Picasso → **P** → **8**

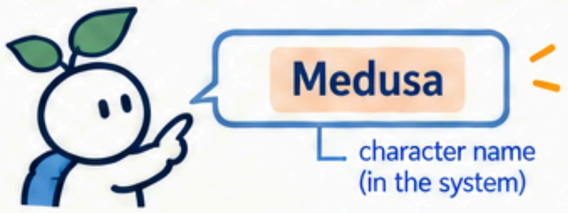


Maria **Curie** → Curie → **C** → **7**

Applies to most categories representuing real people.

2 FOR CATEGORIES 2, 3, 5

USE THE FIRST LETTER OF THE **CHARACTER'S CANONICAL NAME**





Medusa → **M** → **2**



Shrek → **S** → **0**



Gandalf → **G** → **3**



Neo → **N** → **2**

What matters is the name under which the character is represented in the system.

QUICK SCHEME



real person
→ **surname**



Myths / Graphics / Unreal
→ **character name**



first letter
→ **digit Y**

REMEMBER

REAL PEOPLE
→ usually the surname

2 / 3 / 5
→ character name

Y = a letter converted into a digit

Y identifies a specific character within category X.

EXTENSIBLE PAO SYSTEM

MODULE: CLASSIFICATION

Classification concerns the representation of the Person, not the full biography.
What the image shows determines the category.

MAIN RULE

YOU CLASSIFY THE REPRESENTATION, NOT THE BIOGRAPHY

The classified entity is the canonical visual representation.

biography → **representation**

In this system, the representation is what matters.



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THE SAME PERSON, DIFFERENT REPRESENTATIONS

the same person

PERFORMER REPRESENTATION



→ **0** SHOWBUSINESS

when the image encodes a performer

the same person

HISTORICAL-POLITICAL REPRESENTATION



→ **6** HISTORY

when the image encodes a historical or political figure

QUICK TEST

1. What does the image actually represent?
2. Look at the representation, not the whole biography.
3. Without the actor's face, is the role still recognizable?
4. **YES** → classify the **role**
5. **NO** → classify the **actor**

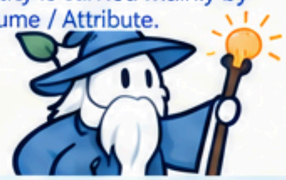
Ambiguous?
Avoid it or redesign the Person.

ACTOR OR ROLE?

FACE-REMOVAL TEST

ROLE

If the character remains recognizable after removing the actor's natural face, classify the **ROLE**.
Identity is carried mainly by Costume / Attribute.



e.g. Gandalf • Jack Sparrow

ACTOR

If the representation loses its identity without the actor's face, classify the **ACTOR**.
Identity is carried mainly by Face.



role dependent mainly on the actor's face

REPRESENTATION EXAMPLE

Keanu Reeves



→ **0** SHOWBUSINESS

actor as himself

Thomas Anderson



→ **9** LITERATURE

ordinary fictional human character

Neo



→ **5** UNREAL

superhuman / sci-fi character

REMEMBER

representation > biography | one representation = one category | the image determines the category | If still uncertain → redesign the representation

EXTENSIBLE PAO SYSTEM

MODULE: REPRESENTATION

A code should be recognizable with a minimal number of features. Keep only what is necessary for decoding.

MAIN PRINCIPLE

MAXIMUM MEANING WITH MINIMUM IMPOSED FEATURES



too much detail → minimum functional

Remove what does not increase decodability.



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MINIMUM FUNCTIONAL FOR THREE CHANNELS

PERSON

1–2 identifying features

T = Face | K = Costume | At = Attribute

Use exactly 1 or 2 features, if that is sufficient.

1. T is sufficient → use T
2. K is not sufficient → add K or At
3. If still unrecognizable T + K + At → The character is usually just too complex.



face + coat



face + pipe + coat

Assess distinctiveness relative to the rest of the PAO set.

OBJECT

1–2 dominating features

type | shape | color | feature

An object should remain recognizable from afar after 1–2 dominating features.



ball → type + shape



feather → type + shape



cactus → shape + feature

If the object requires many independent descriptions, it is too blurry or too complex.





ACTION

1–2 dominating features

movement / relation | optional: instrument

An action is characterized by a specific movement, relation, or a simple attribute of the action.



run with something → movement with object



hit something → object as the target of the action



cut something with scissors → object as the target of the action with an instrument

Do not add unnecessary details, they make transfer harder. Add them only when they improve distinctiveness.

The fewer unnecessary details, the easier the transfer of actions.

QUICK TEST

1. Is this element still recognizable?
2. If yes — remove it.
3. Are 1–2 dominating features left?
4. Is the remaining element readable after transfer?
5. If 3+ features are needed — simplify or replace it.

Too much detail increases interference.

GOOD VS TOO HEAVY

MINIMUM FUNCTIONAL

- Person: 1–2 features
- Object: 1–2 features
- Action: 1–2 features

TOO HEAVY

- Too many unnecessary details
- Takes up more space in working memory
- Higher risk of confusion

REMEMBER | less, but diagnostically | 1–2 features are usually sufficient | remove what does not encode | if 3+ features are needed → simplify | Readability > richness of detail

EXTENSIBLE PAO SYSTEM

MODULE: TESTING

A good action must remain readable after transfer to different objects. After the transfer you must still recognize both the action and the object.

MAIN PRINCIPLE

AN ACTION MUST SURVIVE TRANSFER
THE OBJECT MUST ALSO REMAIN READABLE

Geometry, material, scale and object type can change.





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TEST THE ACTION ON DIFFERENT OBJECTS

1. GOOD TEST

Transfer the same action to very different objects.



CUTTING



cutting a cactus



cutting a ball



cutting a fish



cutting a sheet

If in all cases you still see **CUTTING**, the action is transferable.

2. WHAT REMAINS READABLE?



ACTION

- movement / relation remains recognizable
- e.g. an instrument is still visible
- it still clearly shows the same activity

OBJECT

- the object remains readable
- 1–2 dominating features
- the action does not erase the object's identity

VALID = readable action + readable object

3. TYPICAL MISTAKES

Action disappears

After the transfer it's not clear what is happening.



Object disappears

Only an effect remains, but you can no longer see what the object was.



Too abstract

Do not evaluate physical realism. Assess decodability.



QUICK TEST

1. Does the action still look the same as the original?
2. Is the new object recognizable?
3. Does the test work for objects with different shapes and materials?
4. Is there no competing second object?
5. If not — simplify or replace the action.

A transfer test checks decodability, not realism.

4. GOOD VS WEAK ACTIONS

GOOD ACTIONS

- readable after transfer
- work on different objects
- do not require specific object
- keep the same meaning

running • **holding** • **hitting**

WEAK ACTIONS

- readable only for one object
- require specific object or geometry
- erase the object or create a new, unrelated goal
- too abstract after transfer

balancing on a needle • milking • threading a ring

REMEMBER | test on different objects | action must survive transfer | object must not disappear | readability > realism | **A good action = stable after transfer**

EXTENSIBLE PAO SYSTEM

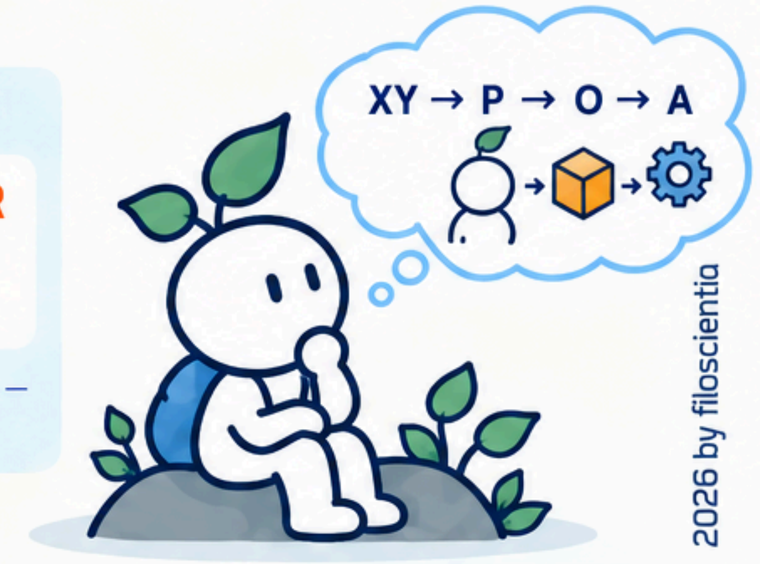
MODULE: P-A-O RELATIONS

The code identifies a character:
an object connects the character with an action.

MAIN PRINCIPLE

THE CODE IDENTIFIES A CHARACTER
AN OBJECT LINKS THE CHARACTER WITH AN ACTION

The 2-digit code does not directly select an action or an object — it primarily indicates a character.



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HOW TO READ IT?

1. You see XY



2. You recognize the **character**



3. the character brings to mind an **object**



4. the object brings to mind an **action**



P–O–A ARCHITECTURE

XY ⟷  ⟷  → 

XY	CHARACTER	OBJECT	ACTION
selects a specific character	brings to mind its object	semantic bridge	retrieved through the object

WHY IS THE OBJECT KEY?



1. links the code with the action
2. allows returning from the object to the character
3. does not require a strong direct P → A

Object = central semantic bridge

IMPORTANT

P → A
is not required

- strong P ↔ O
- strong O → A
- P → A (optional)

A direct association character → action helps, but is not necessary.

REMEMBER

formal coding, meaning, relation

XY selects a character | a character leads to an object | an object leads to an action

EXTENSIBLE PAO SYSTEM

MODULE: USAGE

This is how you use the system to encode digit strings into scenes.
In the 2-digit system, one complete PAO scene encodes 6 digits.

MAIN PRINCIPLE

1 SCENE = 6 DIGITS

PP + AA + OO = 6 digits

character	action	object

first pair = character · second pair = action · third pair = object



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FROM A DIGIT STRING TO SCENES

1 SPLIT THE LONG STRING

427318905264113807

↓

427318 | 905264 | 113807

SCENE 1 | SCENE 2 | SCENE 3

Each next 6 digits are encoded as a new scene.

2 TAKE ONE SIX-DIGIT CHUNK

427318

↓

42 | 73 | 18

You split one six-digit chunk into 3 pairs of digits.

3 ASSIGN ROLES

42	73	18
= character	= action	= object

Each pair goes into a different PAO slot.

4 BUILD ONE SCENE



CHARACTER 42	ACTION 73	OBJECT 18

The character from the first pair performs the action from the second pair on the object from the third pair.

IN PRACTICE

- dates
- phone numbers
- PINs and codes
- scores and statistics
- any information converted into digits

TIP: you can place finished scenes in sequence in a memory palace.

RECALL WORKS IN REVERSE



character | action | object → 42 | 73 | 18 → 427318

First you recall the scene, then you recover the three digit pairs.

IMPORTANT

- keep the order: character → action → object
- 1 scene = exactly 6 digits
- next 6 digits = next scene
- do not mix up slot roles

REMEMBER | 6 digits = 1 scene | 2 digits for character, action, and object | split a long string into 6-digit chunks | place finished scenes in consecutive locations

EXTENSIBLE PAO SYSTEM

MODULE: ADVANTAGES

A SYSTEM THAT GROWS WITH YOUR NEEDS

More structure means easier encoding and recall.



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1 EASY EXTENSION AND REDUCTION

You build from left to right — you can easily narrow down or expand the system.



X
character identified by category

XY
character identified by surname

XYZ
character identified by first name and surname

SIMPLER (e.g. 1 digit) ← → MORE DETAILED (e.g. 3, 4+ digits)

2 CATEGORIZATION MAKES MEMORY EASIER

The first digit immediately tells you what type of character to look for, which reduces the search space.



The category narrows the choice and supports both memorization and recall.

3 STRICT RULES FOR BUILDING IMAGES

Clear rules for building characters, actions, and objects minimize the risk of mistakes.

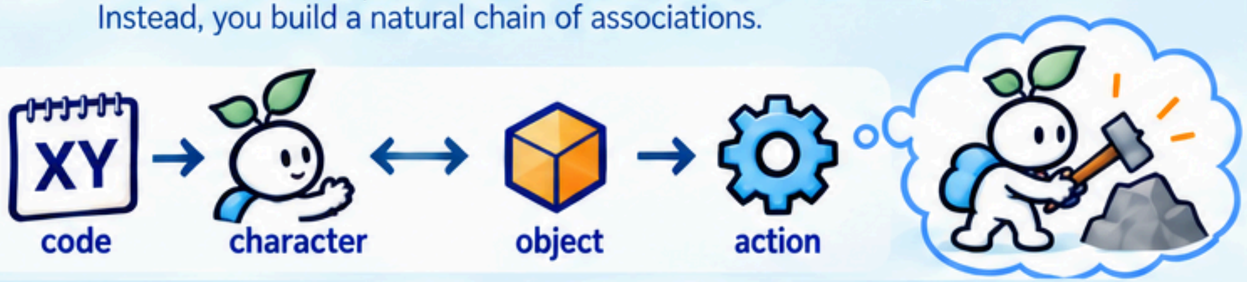
- minimum functional form
- representation classification
- diagnostic features
- transferable actions
- clear and recognizable objects



Less arbitrariness = fewer errors and more stable memories.

4 A CHAIN OF ASSOCIATIONS INSTEAD OF 3 INDEPENDENT MAPPINGS

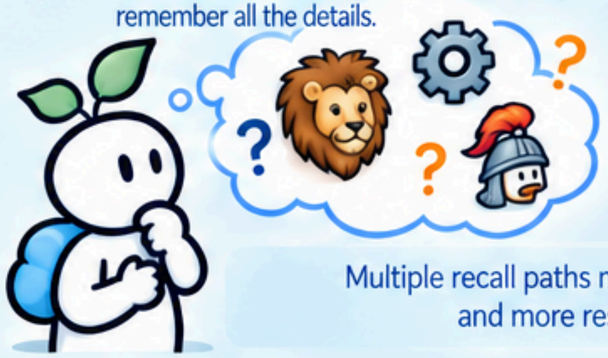
You do not learn separate codes for character, action, and object. Instead, you build a natural chain of associations.



Code → character → object → action
creates one natural and coherent image.

5 MORE PATHS FOR CODE RECALL

Thanks to categorization and the chain of associations, you can often recover the code even if you do not remember all the details.



You can often recall:

- the category (the first digit)
- the character type
- the object
- the action
- the general scene context

Multiple recall paths make the system more reliable and more resistant to forgetting.

REMEMBER | build from left to right | categorization supports recall | clear rules = fewer errors | a chain of associations | flexible and scalable